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Agile Rates – Configuration and Analytics

Introduction, Objective & Audience

This document covers the steps from sales qualification through to Agile Rate enablement, what is required for configuration to add the Agile Rate functionality to G3, and what are the considerations based on the analytics perspective.

The main audience is Service Delivery and Client Services to assist with enabling IDeaS Agile Rate functionality to G3 RMS.

What does this feature do?

Agile Rates will be deployed in 2 phases.

Phase 1 – Provides the ability for hotels to configure Agile rate products to be priced as a fixed amount or a percentage off, or to be added to, the main pricing output of G3 RMS. Pricing for rates such as advance purchase, loyalty tiers, packages or promotional rates can then be delivered to their respective rate codes into selling systems along with the Main pricing output.

Configuration and maintenance of these rates in selling systems themselves is often complex and time consuming. Phase 1 offers a way to deliver values to these rates via a simpler process – with configuration by season and day of week, length

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of stay, days to arrival and Room Class or any combination thereof. Offering benefits such as:

- More granular adjustments than are commonly easily achievable in selling and distribution systems.
- A single point of distribution for key products.
- The ability to Increase the complexity of your pricing strategy while still maintaining product hierarchy.

Phase 2 – Agile Rates will offer the ability for G3 RMS to independently price these Agile Rate products, as opposed to the user configured fixed amount or percentage derivative. This functionality provides more flexibility in hotel's pricing and distribution strategy, enabling:

- Improved pricing strategies and incremental revenue through dynamic discounting of linked and independent products.
- More granular adjustments than are commonly easily achievable in selling and distribution systems.
- A single point of distribution for key products.
- The ability to Increase the complexity of your pricing strategy while still maintaining product hierarchy.

As of April 2019 – the content of this document relates to Agile Phase 1. Additions for Agile Phase 2 to be added when available – expected Jan/Feb 2020

See section – Any other G3 RMS implications of activating this feature. – needs to be reviewed

Business Use & Any Qualification Steps

Please note: Agile Rates can only be enabled for properties with Continuous Pricing

As Alpha & Beta clients:

- TLUK used Agile to price BAR as a supplement onto the SAVER (discount) product priced by G3RMS Continuous Pricing.
- Scandic intend to price Advanced Purchase, Loyalty and a rate that is changeable but for a Fee (i.e. not BAR) using Agile. (starting Dec 2019 with 3 Hotels – further 3 to be added when phase 2 is ready.
- Four Seasons intend to use Agile to price their Advanced Purchase price point. (Starting Dec 2019 for Dubai and Seoul)

Team can add other possible uses of Agile functionality as they are identified.

Cautionary Point: The volume of messages received from G3 RMS can be a concern for selling system vendors and clients alike. Vendors may charge hotels for each upload received from G3 RMS e.g. for each Agile rate priced.

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For that reason – where the same rate is sold using multiple rate codes – IDEaS clients should use G3 RMS to deliver the initial price point and then use their selling system functionality to populate values into additional rate codes.

For example, a client has an Agile Rate product for Advanced Purchase, ADV. They have a separate rate code for Advanced Purchase sold on Booking.com, ADVBCOM, with the same price as ADV. In this case, only upload values for ADV from G3 RMS and configure ADVBCOM as a derivative rate to have the same price as ADV in the selling system. This way the selling system knows how to price both rate codes but only one Agile rate upload is required.

Integrations Supported?

INBOUND: All integrations that provide IDEaS with the required data extracts i.e. certified integrations.

OUTBOUND: All integrations that support Daily BAR delivering values as decisions. i.e. rather than Rate Plan Name.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Agile Rates can only be enabled for properties with Continuous Pricing

Sales Process

If a client has a business need, meets the integration needs and is willing to pay for the Agile Rates functionality – the following SFDC Products are in place (inactive until feature is changed to Generally Available (GA). Pricing is in bundles of the number of rates to be priced.

- **IDEaS G3 RMS Agile Rates: Setup**
- **IDEaS G3 RMS Agile Rates Qty 1-5: Subscription**
(note: there is also a Qty 6-10 product and Custom product)

Implementation of Agile Rates

The Agile Rate functionality should ideally be added during project phase. This is a chargeable activity and needs required commercial arrangements via Sales team or CPM team.

High level process is:

1. IDEaS to make configuration items visible to the User
2. User completes configuration
3. User to tick the Activate field in the UI – to create decisions
4. User to review outputs
5. ROA to complete pro-active review
6. User to complete Vendor Mapping configuration in G3 **if delivering to HTNG selling system**
7. User to confirm instruction to include Agile in the (next) decision upload
8. IDEaS to activate parameter to include Agile in the decision upload
9. User to spot check successful delivery after next upload of decisions

N.B. Agile rates can be activated at property level or if appropriate at the Client level – i.e. if agreed with client corporate team.

If Activating Agile for properties in Decision Delivery mode

High level process is:

1. IDeaS to make configuration items visible to the User
2. User completes configuration
3. User to tick the Activate field in the UI – to create decisions
4. ROA to complete pro-active review
5. User review Forecasts and Decisions after activation.
6. Users to review outputs on the Pricing Screens
7. User to configure vendor Mapping **if delivering to HTNG selling system**
8. User to confirm instruction to include Agile in the (next) decision upload
9. IDeaS to activate parameter to include Agile in the decision upload
10. User to spot check successful delivery after next upload of decisions

There is no impact on BAR overrides or other overrides when activating Agile Rate functionality.

Agile Phase 2 updates will be provided in due course – planned as separate Alpha_Beta Item.

Configuration for this Feature

IDeaS Back End Configuration:

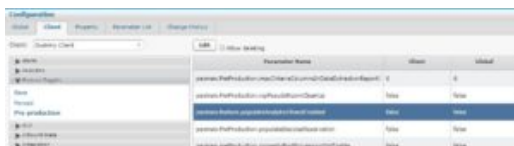
1. 7 Days before Agile rates will be configured (no later than 2). Case to be opened requesting parameter activation of Agile Rates.
- **Case Type:** Installation
 - **Case Subject:** Other Install Related
 - **Case Description:** Activities to enable Agile Rates functionality
 - Date Agile Rates will be configured: xxxx

Task 1 – CARE to configure: *Parameter name:*

pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled= TRUE (*this ensure Analytics tables are ready*)

At least one BDE processing is then required to be completed before the next task is executed. *AUTHOR OF DOCUMENT TO REVIEW THIS STEP WHEN GA – EXPECT THAT THIS PARAMETER WILL BE ACTIVATED SIMULTANEOUSLY WITH ENABLING AGILE RATES*

Support -> Configuration – parameters for this functionality are as shown in the below screenshots –



Parameter Name	Value	Default
pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled	TRUE	FALSE
pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled	TRUE	FALSE
pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled	TRUE	FALSE
pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled	TRUE	FALSE
pacman.feature.populateAnalyticsTransEnabled	TRUE	FALSE

Task 2 – CARE to enable *Parameter name: pacman.feature.AgileRatesEnabled=TRUE* (required to make configuration views available). Also have CARE enable/set the **Parameter Value for ActiveMax = 50 and MaxUploaded = 5**

IMPORTANT: Post activation of this parameter – The next Optimization will **fail and continue to fail** unless configuration of at least one Agile Rate product is completed. Also important to note is that **Manual BAR upload will also be enabled with Agile rates (this was completed in the release for G3 5.6.3)**



Task 3 – Include Agile in Decision Delivery: see section ‘Including Agile Rates outputs in Decision Upload’ later in document for more details

Client UI Configuration

This feature allows clients to configure their Pricing Product just as it is configured in the PMS, as shown in the screenshot below –

Configuration of Agile rates is broken down into 3 sections as follows:

1. Configuring Days to Arrival

Days to Arrival configuration will inform the system of the Days to Arrival windows that discounts/supplements should be applied to linked pricing product. User will be able to configure volume of windows as required for each property and/or product.

Example of completed Days to Arrival configuration as follows:



1. Configuring Package Elements

Package Elements configuration allows the user to configure what packages are linked to the Agile Rates. Package Elements for Agile Rates only need to be configured where the package elements for Agile Rates are different to packages of the Base Product.

2. Configuring Agile Rates

Agile rates configuration is broken down to three screens, Definition, Defaults and Season. A new window will pop-up wherein you need to define the Product. The screenshot of this pop-up is as follows:

The Product Name defined in the above screenshot, should match the rate code name in the selling system

Once the Product is configured, the client would need to configure the Offset as illustrated in the below snippet-

Where required, Seasons would be configured on the next tab

'Activating' Agile Rates functionality – generating pricing against the Agile rate codes

Agile Rates must be 'Active' to:

- Consider the configuration in the overall optimization
- Display Agile Rate values on pricing screen
- Include Agile rates in decision delivery – **plus the Upload tick box selected**

When you tick activate it will impact the analytical outputs of RMS even if you do not upload decisions.

New datasets are activated and populated with the next processing

User Review/validation of Agile outputs in G3 RMS

Pricing decisions for Base rate and Agile rates can be reviewed under Decisions > Pricing. The screen will default to the Base Pricing product. To review any of the agile rates, click on the “Product” dropdown and select applicable pricing product.

Users can drill down by selecting a specific room class in Pricing screen and review all room types within a room class.

Overrides

Users can apply overrides to the required pricing product and/or room class via the pricing screen.

Vendor Integration Mapping (G3 Config area)

Any vendor integration mapping configured will be applied to all decisions submitted to all selling systems.

Configuration of Systems to Receive Agile Rates from G3RMS

For Rate codes in selling system to be updated by G3 RMS:

- Receiving system Rate Codes must match the name of the rate codes configured as Agile Products in G3 RMS. If more assistance is required, client to review required configuration documents or contact vendor.

Including Agile Rates outputs in Decision Upload

As soon as they have configured Agile rates, when they tick Active and run a sync they can verify the RMS outputs before the next processing and we won't upload anything till they tick Upload.

Users can tick the Upload box in the UI once all config is done and ICS have already completed parameter settings. There is no parameter setting specifically to include Agile in the upload – only ticking the Upload box.

ACTION POINT: IF the User wants to review forecasts and decisions suspension of IDPs should be coordinated and re-activated on confirmation of successful decision delivery.

In the UI both 'Active' and 'Upload' need to be ticked to include Agile rates in decision delivery.

Full overlay will be submitted for Agile products only. Previously configured decisions will remain as differential overlay

IDeaS backend Parameters specifically for Decision Upload

The parameters are system specific, meaning if the upload is requested for Opera then it's the Opera Agile rate upload parameter and if it's ORS then it's the ORS Agile rate upload parameter.

- integration.opera.AgileRates.uploadtype- Opera
- integration.ors.AgileRates.uploadtype- ORS
- integration.SiteMinder.AgileRates.uploadtype- SiteMinder

Case entry – Specify the specific Outbound system for activating Agile Rates

Scoping how to view this – QA is working on this enhancement – in the meantime contact Sunny in ICS.

Education & Help

Where Agile rates functionality is included in the implementation – it will be referenced in the OLC session related to Pricing. There is no specific training or Discover materials. Help file section covers all key information: [Agile Rates](#)

FAQ's

Are there any other G3 RMS implications of activating this feature?

Answer: No – the Manual BAR upload will include delivery of Agile rate outputs

How are Agile Rates reported?

Answer: When activating Agile Rates make sure to select the 'Upload' box otherwise you will not see Agile rates coming through the Data Feed. The Pricing Management screen has the option to select an Agile Rate from the drop-down menu.

Will Agile Rates appear on reports?

Answer: The Pricing Report and Data Extraction report will have options to display pricing of the Agile products

Does a client have to use AMS (split segments) to use this feature?

Answer: No.

Are there any LDB Considerations?

Answer: For Phase 1 there are no specific considerations. Phase 2 is when the question of the revenue and booking curve projections for the associated segments becomes relevant.

Is Rollback and catch Up required after activation?

Answer: No

Do Rounding Rules Apply to Agile Rate outputs?

Answer: G3 RMS uses the Final Price from Continuous Pricing as the starting point for calculating the Agile Rates. The system then adds product adjustments. Package values, and rounding to the Final price

How will Agile Rates be affected by the Base Product?

Answer: All products must be the child of a parent, or Base Product. G3 RMS uses the price of the parent product to calculate the price for the child products. The Final Price from the Base Product is the starting point for any products that are based off it

Agile Rates Help Files:

<https://g3rms.ideas.com/help/cp/en/Content/Configuration/Agile-Rates.htm?cshid=1256>

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Tagged on: Agile Rate functionality Agile Rate outputs Agile Rates LDB Considerations

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